IDEMIA
SECURE TRANSACTIONS

A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR MVNO LEADERS

The MVNO Longevity Playbook

Five plays to move from a strong launch to a business built to last

FROM LAUNCH TO LONGEVITY

The market has changed

Launching an MVNO has never been more accessible. Building one that customers trust, rely on and choose again is the harder part.

Trust • Reliability • Operational excellence • Intelligence • Business agility

WHY THIS PLAYBOOK

Launch is a milestone. Longevity is strategy.

eSIM, digital channels, cloud-native platforms and automation have shortened the distance between an idea and a mobile service. That is good news for new entrants. It also means that access to technology is no longer enough to create lasting advantage.

Once the service is live, the questions change. Can customers trust it? Will it work consistently? Can operations absorb growth without absorbing margin? Can the business learn fast enough to prevent churn and adapt before the market moves on?

Launching requires a good idea. Enduring requires capabilities.

How to use this guide

1

Assess

Score your current foundations across five dimensions.

2

Prioritize

Identify the weakest layer that limits the rest.

3

Act

Choose one practical move for the next 90 days.

A USEFUL RULE

Do not start with the most exciting capability. Start with the weakest foundation.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

How prepared is your MVNO to last?

Rate each statement from 1 to 5:

1	2	3	4	5
Not in place	Early stage	Partially in place	Well established	Strong and continuously improved

Use evidence, not optimism: customer outcomes, operational data, incident history, audit results and delivery speed.

DIMENSION	STATEMENT	SCORE 1–5
1 **Trust** — Can customers, regulators and partners trust your service?	**Security & data protection** — We have clear safeguards to protect customer data, credentials and connectivity services.	☐
	Compliance & transparency — We can demonstrate compliance with relevant requirements and clearly communicate how data and service responsibilities are managed.	☐
2 **Reliability** — Can customers depend on your service when it matters?	**Service resilience** — Our critical services are designed to remain available and recover effectively when disruptions occur.	☐
	Customer experience — We monitor critical customer journeys, from activation to connectivity and support, and can identify and address recurring friction.	☐
3 **Operational excellence** — Can you grow without growing complexity at the same pace?	**Automation** — Repeatable processes such as onboarding, provisioning and lifecycle operations require minimal manual intervention.	☐
	Scalable operations — Growth in subscribers, offers or markets does not require a proportional increase in operational effort and cost.	☐

4 Intelligence Can you turn data into better decisions?	**Visibility & insights** We have the data and visibility needed to understand service performance, customer behavior and operational health.	☐
	Actionability We use insights, analytics or AI to identify risks and opportunities early and take action.	☐
5 Business agility Can your business evolve as quickly as your market?	**Speed to market** We can introduce new offers, propositions or use cases without lengthy operational or technical changes.	☐
	Business flexibility Our model gives us enough flexibility to adapt to new markets, partners, customer needs and business models.	☐

YOUR TOTAL SCORE	/ 50	LOWEST-SCORING DIMENSION	

Interpret your score

10–20	**Foundations at risk** Critical capabilities need strengthening before growth adds more pressure.
21–30	**Building for longevity** The foundations are taking shape, but some gaps could limit growth.
31–40	**Ready to scale** You have solid foundations. Focus on strengthening weaker dimensions.
41–50	**Built to last** Your foundations are strong. The challenge is to keep evolving them as the market changes.

Don't just look at your total. Look at your lowest-scoring dimension. A strong overall score can still hide a critical weakness, and your weakest layer may be the one holding the rest of the business back.

YOUR PRIORITY

The layer creating the greatest risk or friction today should shape your next investment decision.

THE MODEL

The longevity pyramid

Each layer makes the next one more valuable. Build from the bottom up, then keep reinforcing every layer as the business grows.

This playbook offers five connected plays. Trust is the foundation. Reliability turns the promise into an everyday experience. Operational excellence protects the economics of growth. Intelligence improves decisions. Business agility keeps the proposition relevant.



↑ BUILD FROM THE BOTTOM UP

01

Trust

Earn the right to exist.

THE CHALLENGE

Connectivity depends on invisible decisions about identity, data, security and control. Customers may not see those decisions, but they feel the consequences when something goes wrong.

▲ WATCH FOR

- Security or compliance requirements treated as late-stage blockers
- Unclear ownership across the MNO, MVNE, MVNO and technology-provider chain
- Customer-facing promises that operations cannot evidence

What to put in place

1. Make security and privacy part of the proposition, not a technical appendix.
2. Design compliance and governance into the operating model from day one.
3. Clarify who controls data, credentials, profiles and customer relationships across the partner chain.
4. Communicate transparently about service responsibilities, incidents and customer support.

START HERE Map the complete trust chain. For every critical asset, name the owner, the control, the evidence and the escalation path.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

The fintech adding mobile connectivity

A fintech adds mobile connectivity to its existing services. Its customers already trust the brand with sensitive information, but becoming part of the connectivity ecosystem introduces new questions around data protection, security, compliance and responsibilities across multiple partners.

Before launching, the team maps who is responsible for what across the ecosystem and makes security and data protection part of the service design, not a final checklist.

The lesson: Trust in the brand needs to extend to the connectivity service behind it.

Why should customers and partners trust you with their connectivity?

Write your answer here

02

Reliability

Deliver consistently every day.

THE CHALLENGE

A strong launch creates attention. Consistent delivery creates habit. For digital connectivity, the experience includes activation, installation, network access, support and recovery, not only platform uptime.

▲ WATCH FOR

- Repeated friction at the same step of activation or installation
- Incident metrics that measure systems but not customer outcomes
- Seasonal or campaign peaks that rely on manual intervention

What to put in place

1. Define the critical customer journeys and the point at which each one can fail.
2. Monitor service performance across platform, profile download, installation and downstream dependencies.
3. Design capacity, resilience and recovery for peaks, not only average demand.
4. Give support teams the context and tools to resolve issues without sending customers through the partner chain.

START HERE Choose one critical journey. Establish its success measure, failure signals, operational owner and recovery playbook.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

The IoT MVNO supporting connected healthcare

An IoT-focused MVNO supports connected healthcare devices. In this environment, connectivity needs to remain dependable throughout the device lifecycle, including when devices move between locations or connectivity conditions change.

The team designs resilience into the service from the start, looking beyond basic availability to how connectivity is monitored, maintained and recovered when something goes wrong.

The lesson: In critical IoT use cases, reliability isn't just part of the experience. It's part of the service promise.

Could customers depend on your service at their most important moment?

Write your answer here

03

Operational excellence

Operate efficiently at growth scale.

THE CHALLENGE

Growth becomes fragile when every new subscriber, brand, market or partner adds manual work. The objective is not automation for its own sake. It is predictable growth with fewer errors, faster delivery and controlled cost.

▲ WATCH FOR

- Every jump in activations immediately calls for more support or operations hires
- Teams maintain the same information across disconnected tools
- Launch timelines depend on individual knowledge or manual handoffs

What to put in place

1. Digitize onboarding and provisioning from the start of the journey.
2. Automate repeatable lifecycle actions and reserve human attention for exceptions.
3. Standardize what should be repeatable while preserving controlled configuration where differentiation matters.
4. Track the cost and effort created by each new subscriber, offer, partner and market.

START HERE List the ten most frequent manual interventions. Remove, automate or redesign the one generating the most volume or risk.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

The MVNO growing faster than its operations

A digital MVNO sees subscriber growth accelerate. That's good news, until each new customer also creates more manual provisioning, lifecycle operations and support requests.

Rather than simply adding people to absorb the workload, the team identifies its most repetitive processes and prioritizes automation where volume and operational effort are growing fastest.

The lesson: Sustainable scale means growing customers faster than operational complexity.

What breaks operationally if your subscriber base doubles?

Write your answer here

04

Intelligence

Make better decisions at scale.

THE CHALLENGE

Data creates no advantage while it remains a dashboard nobody acts on. Intelligence connects a signal to a decision, an owner and a timely response.

▲ WATCH FOR

- Teams debate definitions instead of decisions
- Insights arrive after the moment to act
- Dashboards show activity but not causes, risks or recommended action

What to put in place

1. Agree on the few measures that reflect customer value and operational health.
2. Combine customer, service and operational signals to detect risk earlier.
3. Use analytics to move from reporting what happened to deciding what to do next.
4. Apply AI where it can accelerate analysis, support resolution or surface anomalies, with clear governance.

START HERE Select one recurring decision. Define the signal, threshold, owner, action and feedback loop needed to improve it.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

The IoT MVNO managing a growing device fleet

An IoT MVNO supports a growing number of connected devices across different customers and deployments. As the fleet expands, so does the volume of data about connectivity, usage and service performance. The challenge is no longer accessing the data. It is knowing where to focus.

The team starts using operational insights to identify unusual patterns, spot potential issues earlier and prioritize where intervention is needed, rather than waiting for customers to report a problem.

The lesson: Intelligence turns the complexity of a growing IoT fleet into clearer, faster decisions.

Are you generating more data, or making better decisions?

Write your answer here

05

Business agility

Continuously reinvent the proposition.

THE CHALLENGE

Customer needs, wholesale economics, devices, regulation and competitive models will keep changing. Adaptability is the ability to evolve the proposition without destabilizing everything underneath it.

▲ WATCH FOR

- Every new offer starts as a custom integration
- A change of partner or market requires rebuilding the customer journey
- Innovation is fast in presentation decks but slow in delivery

What to put in place

1. Design offers and integrations as configurable building blocks rather than one-off projects.
2. Keep the freedom to add partners, connectivity options and routes to market.
3. Test new propositions with clear hypotheses and a controlled path to scale.
4. Build lifecycle capabilities that allow active services to evolve, not only new ones.

START HERE Choose one likely change in the next 12 months. Run a tabletop test of the commercial, technical and operational steps needed to respond.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

The consumer MVNO responding to a new customer need

A consumer MVNO spots a growing demand for connectivity abroad. The opportunity is clear, but responding to it means more than creating a new plan: the MVNO needs to expand the proposition without creating a completely separate customer journey or operating model.

The team looks at how its existing capabilities can support the new use case, where additional connectivity or partners are needed, and how quickly the proposition can evolve as customer needs change.

The lesson: Adaptability means being able to turn a new customer need into a new proposition without starting from scratch.

How quickly can you respond when your market changes?

Write your answer here

PUT IT INTO ACTION

Your 90-day longevity sprint

The goal is not to transform all five layers at once. Choose the constraint that matters most, improve it measurably and use the learning to shape the next cycle.

DAYS 1–30
Diagnose

Confirm the weakest layer with evidence. Map the customer journey, dependencies, controls and operational pain.

DAYS 31–60
Design

Select one high-value intervention. Define the owner, outcome, measure, required capability and decision points.

DAYS 61–90
Prove

Run the intervention on a controlled scope. Review results, capture learning and decide whether to scale, adjust or stop.

Define success before you start

Business outcome
What changes for growth, retention, margin or risk?

Customer outcome
What becomes easier, more reliable or more valuable?

Operational outcome
What becomes faster, more automated or more controlled?

Evidence
Which metric or observable result will prove progress?

DECISION DISCIPLINE

At the end of 90 days, make an explicit decision: scale it, change it or stop it. A pilot without a decision is only activity.

KEEP IT VISIBLE

The MVNO longevity formula

TRUST	gives you permission to compete.
RELIABILITY	keeps customers.
OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE	protects margins.
INTELLIGENCE	improves decisions.
BUSINESS AGILITY	keeps the business relevant.

The MVNOs that last will not be defined only by how quickly they launch. They will be defined by what they can consistently deliver, learn and change after launch.

Launching requires a good idea. Enduring requires capabilities.

HOW IDEMIA SUPPORTS THE JOURNEY

Build on capabilities designed for sustainable growth

IDEMIA Secure Transactions provides an eSIM management platform with capabilities that help MNOs, MVNOs and MVNEs operate secure digital connectivity services, absorb growth and evolve their propositions over time.

1 Trust	Protect your eSIM operations with SAS-SM and SOC 2 Type 2 certified services, flexible data-sovereignty options and future-ready security, including post-quantum cryptography and crypto-agility.
2 Reliability	Rely on a proven, global eSIM footprint with cloud-native platforms designed for high availability, resilience and scale, strengthened by AI-based proactive monitoring and self-healing capabilities.
3 Operational excellence	Simplify eSIM operations with digital profile design, generation, provisioning and lifecycle management that reduce inventory complexity and manual intervention.
4 Intelligence	Turn eSIM data into actionable insights with analytics and AI to monitor activity, anticipate needs, investigate operational issues and detect potential fraud.
5 Business agility	Adapt eSIM profiles to changing business needs with Just-in-Time profile generation, dynamic customization and reprocessing, allowing profile elements and metadata to evolve before download without starting from scratch.

OUR ROLE

To provide the secure, resilient and flexible eSIM foundation behind your proposition, so your brand can focus on the customer, the market and the next stage of growth.

IDEMIA SECURE TRANSACTIONS

Continue the conversation

Use your assessment score as the starting point. Bring us the layer you want to strengthen and the business outcome you need to achieve. Together, we can translate it into the platform, lifecycle and operating capabilities required to move forward.

WHO WE ARE

180
countries where we serve clients

500
MNOs who trust us

310+
eSIM platforms deployed*

300+
eSIM platforms running on public cloud

100+
live OTA platforms

99.99%
Availability commitment of our platforms**

* 310+ eSIM platforms deployed: 230+ Consumer · 60+ M2M · 20+ IoT (as of Q1 2026) · ** Data from dual-region platforms.

WHY IDEMIA SECURE TRANSACTIONS

KALEIDO INTELLIGENCE
Champion
eSIM Remote SIM Provisioning Vendor
Vendor Hub, February 2026

COUNTERPOINT RESEARCH
Pacesetter
eSIM Provisioning (Counterpoint CORE)
Global SIM Landscape Report, 2026

HOW TO REACH US

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